University Partner Opportunities

In-Situ Research & Technology Testing....1
Fundamentals of Research Workshop Series....2
Student Research Internship & Mentorship Program (SRIMP)....3
Benefits for State Colleges and Universities....5

In-Situ Research & Technology Testing

Wahoo Bay provides a unique in-situ marine environment where universities and researchers can conduct experiments, pilot studies, train researchers, and test technology within a coastal ecosystem monitored through real-time sensors, data platforms, and environmental monitoring technology.

Overview
Researchers can utilize Wahoo Bay as a field-testing site for marine technologies, ecological studies, and environmental monitoring tools. Wahoo Bay provides site management, logistical coordination, and environmental oversight to ensure projects run smoothly. *A site management or research use donation would support operations, maintenance, and research infrastructure*

Examples of Use
This program can support projects such as:

- Technological Testing:
    - Marine sensor testing
    - Water quality monitoring technologies
    - Autonomous underwater vehicles
    - Habitat Mapping
- Habitat monitoring equipment
    - AI and computer vision systems for species identification
    - Artificial reef components
    - Species monitoring tools
        - Environmental DNA sampling

Wahoo Bay would provide:

- Site access and coordination
- Equipment deployment assistance
- Data integration opportunities with existing Wahoo Bay datasets
- Access to long-term monitoring data

Partners may participate through:

- Short-term testing agreements
- Seasonal research deployments
- Long-term monitoring projects
- Technology pilots

Fundamentals of Research Workshop Series

Training the Next Generation of Marine Scientists and Researchers

Wahoo Bay offers a series of professional development workshops designed to equip students and early-career researchers with the foundational skills needed to design, conduct, and communicate scientific research.

Workshop fees are scaled based on:

1. *Attendees*
2. *Number of workshops requested*

Workshop Topics and Overview

1. Research Design:
   - Research question and hypothesis development
   - Experimental design
   - Data collection strategies

2. Research Ethics:
   - Responsible conduct of research
   - Environmental ethics in marine science
   - Data integrity and transparency

3. Scientific Communication:
   - Designing and delivering effective presentations
   - Communicating science to different audiences
   - Poster design and conference preparation

4. Grant Writing:
   - Identifying funding opportunities
   - Structuring a compelling proposal
   - Budget design
   - Common mistakes in grant writing

5. Career Preparedness:
   - Graduate school pathways
   - Career exploration in marine science, conservation and related fields
   - Networking and professional development

6. Scientific Publishing:
   - Structure of a scientific paper
   - Choosing the right journal
   - Navigating peer review
   - Responding to reviewer feedback

Target Audience:

- 9-12th Grade
- Undergraduate students
- Graduate students
- Early career researchers

These workshops could be offered as:

- Individual workshops
- Multi-week research training programs
- Summer research academies

Student Research Internship & Mentorship Program (SRIMP)

Co-Mentoring Future Scientists

This program is designed to support faculty who wish to bring students to Wahoo Bay to conduct research as part of an existing university research project. In this model, the faculty member serves as the Principal Investigator (PI) while Wahoo Bay staff provide co-mentorship, field expertise, and project coordination. This collaborative structure allows students to conduct meaningful research within a real-world marine environment while benefiting from both academic supervision and applied field mentorship.

Program Structure

Faculty partners bring an existing research project and a cohort of students (e.g., undergraduate researchers, graduate students, or capstone teams) to Wahoo Bay. The faculty member maintains responsibility for the overall research direction, academic supervision, and research outputs. Wahoo Bay serves as a co-mentor and research host, helping guide students through the applied aspects of the research process and ensuring that projects are successfully implemented within the Wahoo Bay ecosystem.

This structure creates a dual-mentorship model that combines university research expertise with hands-on marine field experience, while also giving students access to Wahoo Bay's research training workshops, which provide additional instruction in research design, ethics, scientific communication, and professional development. Together, these components create a comprehensive training experience that supports students from project development through data collection, analysis, and scientific communication.

Faculty can engage with the program through:

- Semester research cohorts
- Summer research programs
- Graduate thesis projects
- Multi-year collaborative research projects

Role of the Faculty PI

The faculty partner is responsible for:

- Defining the research questions and study design
- Securing research funding where applicable
- Selecting and supervising participating students
- Overseeing data analysis and publication development

Role of Wahoo Bay (Co-Mentor)

Wahoo Bay may assist with:

- Translating research designs into feasible field methods
- Site related permitting where applicable
- Partnering on grants, writing LOI's for grant proposals/applications, and potentially act as grant manager or fiscal agent (if the need arises)
- Providing guidance on marine ecosystem dynamics at the site
- Assisting students with field data collection techniques
- Helping coordinate field schedules and site logistics
- Supporting students through the research process
- Providing feedback on presentations
- Connecting projects with Wahoo Bay datasets and monitoring programs
- Connecting projects with vetted community conservation team members

Benefits for Faculty and Students

Participating faculty and students gain access to:

- A local marine research environment
- Applied field mentorship from marine professionals
- Logistical and coordination support for field research
- Opportunities to integrate projects with Wahoo Bay monitoring datasets
- Experience translating research into real-world conservation applications

Students benefit from working within a collaborative mentorship structure that provides:

- Daily mentorship and guidance from both faculty and Wahoo Bay staff throughout the research process
- Hands-on field research experience that builds confidence in data collection, analysis, and scientific problem-solving
- Place-based learning opportunities that allow students to conduct research within a local marine ecosystem at Wahoo Bay
- Exposure to real-world conservation and environmental challenges, helping students connect scientific research to practical applications
- Opportunities to develop and present scientific findings, strengthening communication skills through presentations, reports, and potential publications
- Access to Wahoo Bay's research training workshops, which support skill development in research design, scientific communication, grant writing, and professional development
- Opportunities to pursue student-funded research, including guidance on identifying and applying for grants, fellowships, and student research funding
- Opportunities to contribute to ongoing long-term datasets and monitoring programs at Wahoo Bay, allowing students to participate in research that supports broader scientific understanding and ecosystem management
- Networking opportunities with researchers, conservation professionals, and technology partners, helping students build professional connections and explore future career pathways in marine science

Benefits for State Colleges and Universities

Participation in undergraduate research and other high-impact educational practices, such as internships, field-based learning, and experiential workforce training, has been widely shown to improve student success and academic outcomes. Research consistently demonstrates that students who engage in these types of experiences are more likely to remain enrolled at their institution, persist within their chosen major, and graduate in a shorter timeframe compared to peers who do not participate in applied learning opportunities.

Experiential programs provide students with opportunities to move beyond traditional classroom learning and actively apply their knowledge to real-world challenges. Through direct engagement in research, environmental monitoring, conservation projects, and workforce development initiatives, students strengthen critical thinking, problem-solving, collaboration, and communication skills that are highly valued across both scientific and professional careers.

Field-based learning opportunities also serve as a powerful extension of students' existing academic coursework. By connecting classroom concepts with hands-on research and environmental observation, students gain a deeper understanding of scientific methods, ecological systems, and data-driven decision making. Experiences such as conducting field sampling, participating in long-term monitoring programs, and working within active research projects allow students to see how theories and techniques introduced in their courses are applied in real-world settings. These experiences can reinforce course content, increase student engagement, and help students develop a stronger sense of relevance and purpose in their academic studies.

Programs at Wahoo Bay are intentionally designed to expand access to these high-impact experiences. Unlike many traditional research or internship opportunities that require students to be full-time, degree-seeking participants within a specific institution, Wahoo Bay initiatives are structured to support a broader and more inclusive range of learners. Opportunities may be available to:

- Full-time and part-time college students; Degree-seeking and non-degree-seeking learners
- Students from high schools, state colleges, and universities
- Participants pursuing research experiences, workforce development, or professional skill development

This flexible structure allows students who might otherwise face barriers to participation—such as scheduling constraints, institutional limitations, or program eligibility requirements—to engage meaningfully in research and career preparedness. By providing accessible pathways into research and applied environmental work, Wahoo Bay helps students build academic momentum, strengthen career readiness, and develop the skills, networks, and confidence needed to pursue future opportunities in marine science, environmental research, conservation, engineering, marketing and related fields.